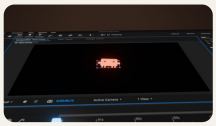
CHARACTER FILM / 12 S / 16:9 / 30 FPS

No After Effects.
Just Clawd.

Clawd starts as a flat PNG layer inside an After Effects-style comp. He peels himself off the screen, pops into 3D and builds the whole motion graphic by jumping on the buttons: Type, Rectangle, Pen, Glow, four keyframes, a ride on the playhead, Play. Then the editor falls apart and only his work is left. The interface, the scene and the sound were all written by Claude Opus 5.5 from the prompt on page 2.



12.0 s	30 fps	1920x1080	10 hits	390	3
120 BPM, 24 BEATS	360 FRAMES	CYCLES ON THE GPU	BUTTONS, KEYS, PLAYHEAD	WORDS OF PROMPT	FOLLOW-UPS



1.30 S
FLAT PNG



2.10 S
POP



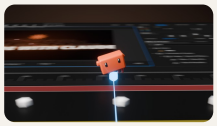
3.00 S
TOOLS



5.00 S
KICK GLOW



7.00 S
KEYFRAMES



9.00 S
PLAYHEAD

THE FORMULA

01 Build the UI in HTML
Real panels, labels and icons as a web page, screenshot at 3x: crisp as a real app, and every pixel position is known.

02 One layout, three readers
timeline.py holds each button in UI pixels; the HTML, the 3D buttons and the sound read the same numbers.

03 Slabs, not a screenshot
Each panel is its own slab with its own piece of the texture, so they can light up, press and fall one by one.

04 The comp is a canvas
What Clawd builds is drawn per frame from the playhead time, so keyframes and the ride follow real AE logic.

05 Hide the lights from glass
Glossy UI mirrors big area lights as white blocks; the rim and top lights stay out of its reflections.

06 Measure, don't guess
Contact sheets of the comp and of 18 stills before the full render; loudness per half second for the mix.

PAGE 02 **The prompt**, copy-ready.

PAGE 03 **Every follow-up**, in order.

PAGE 04 **Make it yours**, render it fast.

PAGE 05 **Every hit** on its frame.

PAGE 06 **Sound**, prompt and check.

The prompt

COPY-READY 390 WORDS

Paste it as is into Claude Code running Opus 5.5 at effort high, with Blender 5, Node with puppeteer and ffmpeg installed. It writes the interface as HTML, the scene as Python, renders headless on the GPU and checks its own stills.

```
BRAND
HERO: Clawd, the Claude Code mascot as one smooth toy: body 12x8x6 units, two side nubs, four short legs, two black eye slits, soft rounded bevels, no voxel grid, terracotta D97757
APP: a pixel-faithful After Effects-style workspace, dark theme: menu bar, toolbar (Home, Selection ... Rectangle, Pen, Type ... Puppet), Project, Composition, Info, Preview, Effects & Presets searched for "glow", and a Timeline with five layers and open Position and Scale rows. Real layout and labels, no logos
RESULT: the comp Clawd builds: "MADE WITH CLAUDE", an orange spark, a pen swoosh, a glow, the subtitle OPUS 5.5
SET: every panel is a floating slab over a dark warm studio; the UI glows like a screen

FORMAT: Blender 5 Python, Cycles GPU, 1920x1080, 30 fps, 12.0 s at 120 BPM. Build the interface in HTML and screenshot it with puppeteer into a 3840x2160 texture; draw the comp and the timecode on a canvas, one PNG per frame. One timeline.py holds the layout in UI pixels and every event; the HTML, the Blender scene and the sound all read it.

BEATS (seconds):
0-1.5 Clawd is a flat clawd.png layer in the comp, selection handles around him; he knocks twice from inside
1.5-2.0 peels off the screen as a flat card and pops into 3D; the viewer glass cracks, shards fly
2.5-3.5 lands on Type, Rectangle and Pen: each press types the title, pops the spark, draws the swoosh
4.5-5.5 flips across to Effects > Glow, a Glow chip pops up, he kicks it into the comp: glow on
6.0-7.5 four hops along the Position row; each stamps a keyframe and the comp jumps to that pose
8.0-9.6 hops on the playhead, it rewinds to 0, he surfs it to the end while the comp plays
10-12 Preview > Play; every other panel powers down and falls away; Clawd waves next to the finished comp

CAMERA: starts wide on the whole workspace, follows every hop at Clawd height with shallow focus, whips to each button, ends on the comp alone.

LOOK: UI as emission under black glossy glass; keep the lights out of the UI reflections so nothing blows out; bloom, 0.5 shutter blur, AgX; the body must read D97757.

CHECKS: render the UI texture and a comp contact sheet first, then 18 stills at half res before the full render.
```

BRAND	**The block you swap.** HERO, APP, RESULT, SET. The rest of the prompt only uses these names.
APP	Name every panel and the state it is in. The more real the labels, the more the film reads as the real app.
FORMAT	HTML for the interface, a canvas for the comp, Blender for the world: each tool does what it is best at.
BEATS	Every hop lands on something that changes the comp. A jump that changes nothing is cut.
LOOK	The one line that fixed the first previews: glossy screens and big area lights fight.
CHECKS	Makes Opus look before it spends GPU time. Most of the polish comes from this line.

Every follow-up

3 ROUNDS

After each contact sheet I wrote what I saw and what to change, in order. These are the notes; the pictures below are the same frame before and after follow-up 2.

FOLLOW-UP 1 / AFTER THE COMP CONTACT SHEET

```
The spark is ten hairlines: make every ray twice as wide. At the third keyframe
the title runs off the right edge: pull that pose in to 190 px right at 100%.
OPUS 5.5 is too small to read in the panel: 78 px.
```

FOLLOW-UP 2 / AFTER THE FIRST 18 STILLS

```
The rim and top lights show up in the glossy panels as huge white blocks. Hide
them from glossy rays, drop the UI specular to 0.1 and roughen it to 0.32. Clawd
reads salmon: exposure 0.6 to 0.15 and the body base to 0.5, 0.085, 0.03. In the
last shot he stands on OPUS 5.5: land him on the comp panel's right corner and
raise the camera.
```

FOLLOW-UP 3 / AFTER THE FULL RENDER

```
Two misses in the full render. Mid-leap to Glow he flies out of the top of the
frame: lower that apex from 0.55 to 0.36 m. In the last frame he is half off the
right edge: land him at x 800 instead of 862 and move the camera right and back.
Re-render only frames 105 to 145 and 285 to 360.
```

FOLLOW-UP 1

Result: the spark reads as a shape, the title stays in frame.

FOLLOW-UP 2

Result: no blown highlights; the body reads terracotta (pictures below).

FOLLOW-UP 3

Result: Clawd stays in frame on the leap; title, subtitle and Clawd in one clean end frame.

FULL RENDER

Result: 1.47 s a frame on an RTX 4070 SUPER, 360 frames in 8.8 min plus 117 re-rendered; 9.6 MB MP4.

FOLLOW-UP 2 IN ONE PICTURE: 3.03 S, ON THE TOOLBAR



Before: the lights mirror in the glass panels; the body reads salmon.

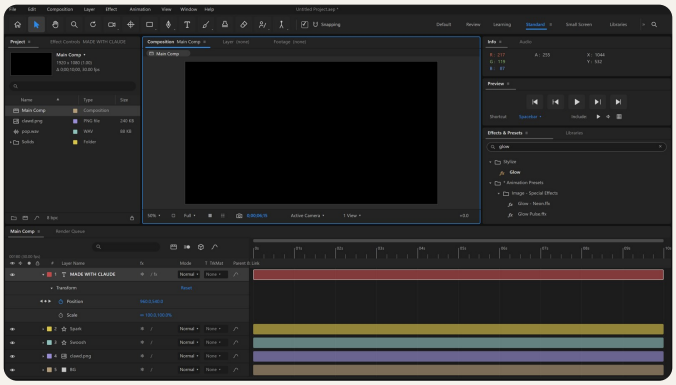


After: lights hidden from the UI glass, deeper body, lower exposure.

Make it yours

Only the BRAND block changes. Below: the interface texture and the comp exactly as Opus built them before any 3D. Swap APP for any program you want to "replace" and RESULT for what the hero should make in it.

```
BRAND (an example swap, not rendered)
HERO: the same
APP: a Premiere-style editor: Source, Program, Project bin, an Effects panel searched for "warp", a timeline with V1 V2 A1 tracks and clips
RESULT: a cut-down trailer: three clips snapped together, a title, a warp transition
SET: the same
```



ui.png, 3840x2160: the whole workspace from HTML, before it is cut into slabs.



The comp at 3.6, 5.6, 7.0 and 11 s: the canvas that plays on the 3D screen.

Render it fast

1. Build the UI: `python build_ui.py`, then `node render_ui.js` for ui.png, the 360 comp frames and the timecode.
2. Build the .blend from scene.py with `blender -b --factory-startup -P scene.py`.
3. Preview 18 stills at 50% and 40 samples first and read them as one contact sheet.
4. Pass `-P gpu.py` on every render: the OptiX device is a user preference, not part of the file.
5. Encode H.264 High CRF 17, 30 fps, soft vignette, mux the WAV as AAC 320k, +faststart.

Every hit on its frame

Read straight from timeline.py; the frame is time x 30 + 1. At 120 BPM a beat is 0.5 s, so every landing, click and keyframe sits on a beat.

TIME	FRAME	PICTURE	SOUND
0.00 to 1.50 s	f1 to f46	wide on the workspace; flat Clawd in the comp, handles around him, two knocks	soft pad, ticking hats, two glass knocks
1.50 to 1.90 s	f46 to f58	he peels up off the screen as a flat card	sticker peel, riser
2.00 s	f61	pop into 3D, cracks in the comp, shards	pop, glass, sub boom, the beat drops
2.50 s	f76	Type tool, the title types on	keycap click, blip, 16 key taps
3.00 / 3.50 s	f91 / f106	Rectangle: spark; Pen: swoosh	clicks, bloop, pen scribble
4.50 s	f136	front flip onto Effects > Glow, the chip pops up	whoosh, landing, select blip
5.00 to 5.50 s	f151 to f166	kick, the chip flies into the comp: glow on	thwack, whoosh, magic shimmer, bells
6.0 to 7.5 s	f181 to f226	four keyframes stamped on Position, one a beat	rising dings C E G C
8.00 to 8.40 s	f241 to f253	onto the playhead, it rewinds to 0	tape rewind chirps
8.50 to 9.60 s	f256 to f289	he surfs the playhead, the comp plays	skate roll, scrub ticks
10.00 s	f301	Preview > Play: flash, particles, OPUS 5.5	click, C major brass, shimmer
10.45 to 11.20 s	f314 to f337	every other panel powers down and falls	six power-downs, boom, yay chirps
11.20 to 12.00 s	f337 to f360	Clawd waves, ^^ eyes, the comp alone	chord rings out, fade

3 TIPS

1

Pixels are the API

Keep the layout in UI pixels; one function turns them into metres for Blender.

2

Show the software logic

Keyframes jump the comp to their pose, the playhead plays it: anyone who knows AE smiles.

3

Every jump changes something

A hop that presses nothing is filler; cut it or give it a button.

Sound

COPY-READY 220 WORDS

The picture comes from the prompt on page 2; the sound came from this one more prompt, driven by the same timeline.py.

```
Add sound. Synthesize everything in Python with numpy, scipy and pedalboard: no samples, no words. 48 kHz stereo WAV, 12.0 s, read every event from timeline.py and land each hit on its frame.

Music: a cute lo-fi beat at 120 BPM. Before the pop only a soft pad and ticking hats; the beat drops on the pop: kick, snare, hats, a rubbery bass on F G Am C, glassy FM keys on the off-beats, a kick pump on the bed. On Play a C major brass stab, then the chord rings out to a 0.5 s fade.

Effects: two glass knocks, a sticker peel, a pop with breaking glass and a sub boom; a boing on every take-off and a soft pomf on every landing, whooshes on the big leaps; a chunky keycap click and a UI blip on each tool, a key tap for every typed letter, a bloop for the spark, a pen scribble; a thwack for the kick, a whoosh for the chip and a magic shimmer with bells for the glow; rising glockenspiel dings C E G C for the keyframes; tape-rewind chirps, a skate roll and scrub ticks for the playhead; a power-down zap and a whoosh for each falling panel; yay chirps and sparkles at the end.

Master: a compressor and a limiter at -1 dBFS.
```

The check I ran

LOUDNESS PER HALF SECOND, BEFORE ANY SOUND FOLLOW-UP

-28 dB in the first half second, -21 dB during the knocks, -14 dB on the peel, then -11 to -12 dB from the pop to the end, and -19 dB in the fade. The drop lands where the picture explodes and nothing pokes out above the groove, so no sound follow-up was needed.

Into the MP4: the WAV was muxed in as the video's AAC 320k track with ffmpeg; the same step works for your own video.